New non application ideas:

Concept	What it could look like	What it lets you investigate
1. QR / NFC shelf prompts	Small mock supermarket shelf labels that a student scans with their phone. Instead of saying "healthier choice", it might say **"What matters to you today?"** → cheap / quick / vegetarian / high protein / familiar food / dietary requirement.	Whether people want support **at the exact decision point**, without needing a full app.
2. Friend Recommendation Cards	Digital cards or QR codes friends can send each other: *"I bought this because..."*, *"good cheap dinner"*, *"easy after uni"*.	Whether the important part is actually **personal recommendations**, rather than likes, feeds or group goals. Your existing interviews already suggest recommendations from friends can lead to purchases.
3. Shopping Buddy / Messaging Prototype	Rather than a new app, prototype something that could work through Messenger/WhatsApp/SMS: *"I'm at the shops — what should I cook?"* Friends respond with suggestions or vote between options.	**Social context** rather than simply adding "social features". Who do people actually ask? When? Why do they trust them?
4. Context-aware phone prompt	A fake notification appears when entering the supermarket: **"What are you shopping for today?"** The student chooses priorities such as price, convenience, dietary needs or meal ideas.	Whether location-aware support is useful at all, and whether it changes behaviour compared with receiving nothing.
5. Shared Household Shopping Board	A simple shared digital board where housemates add meals, foods they already own, requests and who is buying what. Could be prototyped as a webpage, physical board or shared phone screen.	How other people around the student influence shopping, waste, cost and food choice. This expands your original housemate concept without committing to an app.
6. "Someone	Instead of recommendations	What makes

Like Me" recommendations	simply from friends, suggestions come with context: *"Student living alone — $12, 3 meals"* or *"Vegetarian student — 15 minute dinner."*	recommendations feel relevant: friendship, shared circumstances, culture, budget, dietary needs, etc.
7. Digital decision card	When comparing two supermarket products, the phone doesn't tell the user which is "healthier". It asks **"Which matters most right now?"** Price / taste / nutrition / dietary requirements / convenience / sustainability.	What "better food choice" actually means to different users rather than imposing your definition of healthy.
8. Social shopping presence	Prototype simply showing that a friend bought, cooked or recommended something recently: *"Alex made this last night."* No likes, leaderboards or challenges.	Whether the effect comes from **social presence/social norms**, rather than explicit social-media features.

Here are some stronger non-phone concepts:

- **Smart trolley attachment** — A small screen or device clipped onto a shopping trolley. It could ask what matters today, like budget, dietary needs, convenience, or shared household needs, then give prompts while the person shops. This would let you explore whether support works better when it is built into the shopping environment rather than something the user has to open themselves.
- **Interactive shelf display** — A small electronic display beside products that changes depending on context. For example, it could show “popular with students,” “good for 3 cheap meals,” “vegetarian option,” or “commonly bought with...” rather than simply labelling something as “healthy.” This could help you investigate what information actually matters at the moment someone is choosing between products.
- **Shared kitchen hub** — A small touchscreen or physical-digital device placed in a share house kitchen. Housemates could indicate what food is running low, meals they want to cook, food that needs using soon, or who is shopping next. This connects especially well with the shared-household aspect already present in your target audience.

- **Smart fridge / pantry display** — A simple standalone display attached to a fridge or pantry that shows what the household already has, what needs using, and meal ideas based on those ingredients. It could also show shared suggestions from housemates, so the social part comes from the household rather than an online "friends feed."
- **Physical recommendation token system** — Imagine small electronic tags, buttons or cards that friends/housemates use to recommend foods or meals. For example, someone presses a button next to "cheap dinner," "quick meal," or "good for sharing," and those recommendations become visible to the next person shopping or planning meals. It is more experimental, but it could be a really interesting way to study **social context without copying social media features**.
- **Smart shopping basket display** — A basket with a small built-in display that gives simple prompts based on what has already been added. Rather than saying "this is healthy," it might say, "You said you wanted 3 quick dinners — you currently have ingredients for 1." That keeps the system focused on the user's own goal instead of imposing a universal idea of health.
- **Store entrance kiosk** — A small kiosk near the supermarket entrance where the shopper chooses what matters for that trip: "cheap," "quick," "vegetarian," "cooking for housemates," "high protein," "allergy-safe," etc. It could then print a small card or generate a simple shopping route. This would be particularly useful for testing your tutor's question of **what 'healthy' actually means to different people**.
- **Social grocery voting board** — A physical digital board in student accommodation where residents can vote on meals, ingredients, cheap finds or things worth buying that week. This tests whether people are influenced by the wider social environment around them, rather than just direct recommendations from individual friends.

A really interesting distinction for your project could be:

App-style idea:
"Your friend recommended this."

versus

Standalone social technology:
“This shopping environment shows what your household, peers, or people with similar needs find useful.”

That gets closer to the tutor’s point about **social contexts vs social features**.

If I had to narrow it down to the **three strongest concepts to take into interviews**, I’d use:

1. **Smart trolley attachment** — tests support during the shopping trip.
2. **Shared kitchen hub** — tests househo
3. ld/social influence before shopping.
4. **Interactive shelf display** — tests influence at the exact moment of choosing a product.

Scan&Go idea from Woolies:

Instead of creating an app, we could focus on the idea of a physical device built into the shopping trolley, similar to Woolworths Scan & Go. The trolley itself becomes part of the technology, so shoppers can interact with it while they are already shopping. For example, shoppers could scan food items and receive simple feedback about their choices through the small screen. This means they do not have to constantly take out their phone or open an app. The technology would be used at the moment a food choice is being made, helping the shopper pause and think about their decision rather than just making shopping faster. This connects to tangible computing because a familiar physical object becomes the interface, and slow computing because the technology encourages a small moment of reflection rather than focusing only on efficiency.

Things to think about:

Would students be using the trollies? I.e. would they need to purchase that amount of groceries that would need them to use a trolley? Is there a way to incorporate it without it >would most of our intended user just use baskets or just there for the quick 2-3 items.

Could the device make shopping more inconvenient? Having to scan every item might feel like extra effort, especially for people who are in a hurry. (If we were to make it work the way scan and go works)

Would students actually want health feedback while shopping? Some people might find it annoying, judgemental, or intrusive → or would it be help full like the team goal idea

Could the feedback be too simplistic? Labelling food as “good” or “bad” might not account for different diets, budgets, allergies, or personal preferences, how does people perspective on health really affect.

Could it influence people too much? There is a risk that the system starts telling people what they should buy rather than supporting their own decisions.

Would it be expensive for supermarkets to implement? Adding scanners, screens, sensors, or other technology to every trolley could be costly.

What happens if the technology doesn't work? Scanners could fail, products might not scan correctly, or the device could run out of power.

Would people understand how to use it? The interaction would need to be very obvious so shoppers aren't confused about what they are supposed to do.

Could privacy become an issue? If the system records what someone buys, there could be concerns about collecting or storing personal shopping information.

Does the physical device actually need to be on the trolley? There might be a better location, such as the basket, trolley handle, checkout area, or even the shelf itself.